i360 Pricing

▼ Insight 360 Platform Briefing

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Executive Summary

Insight 360 (i360) is an enterprise-grade, values-based AI command center that transforms how organizations align strategy with execution. The platform combines multi-LLM orchestration, strategic planning frameworks, and organizational governance into a unified system that ensures AI adoption is both effective and aligned with core business values.

Key Value Propositions

For	Value Delivered
Enterprises	Unified AI governance, strategic alignment, and integrity monitoring
Consultancies/Agencies	Scalable client assessment and transformation services
Department Leaders	AI-powered execution tools aligned with organizational strategy
Executives	Real-time visibility into AI maturity, readiness, and strategic progress

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Platform Overview

Core Philosophy: Values-Based AI

Unlike generic AI platforms, Insight 360 is built on the principle that **AI adoption must be governed by organizational values**. The platform ensures that every AI interaction, strategic decision, and execution action is filtered through:

- **Bright Lines** - Ethical boundaries that cannot be crossed
- **Values Mapping** - Alignment between stated values and actions
- **Trust Velocity** - Measurable trust-building over time
- **Integrity Yield** - Outcomes that reinforce organizational integrity

Architecture at a Glance

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│              INSIGHT 360 PLATFORM                  │
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│ Multi-LLM Orchestration │ Context Engine │ Agent Framework   │
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│ Anthropic Claude │ OpenAI GPT │ Google Gemini │ Perplexity   │
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The Three-Lane Transformation Framework

Insight 360's differentiated approach guides organizations through a complete AI transformation journey:

Lane 1: ALIGN 120 - Company Assessment

Purpose: Establish baseline understanding of AI maturity, readiness, and strategic position.

Process:

1. **Discovery** - Company profile, industry context, competitive landscape
2. **Scope Assessment** - Vision, strategy, market position analysis
3. **Capability Assessment** - Current AI capabilities, technology stack, skills gap
4. **Integrity Assessment** - Values alignment, ethical considerations, governance readiness

Outputs:

- AI Maturity Score (1-5 scale across 12 dimensions)
- AI Readiness Score (organizational preparedness)
- Strategic Recommendations Report
- Transformation Roadmap

Unique Value: Each client maintains exactly ONE evolving company profile that grows richer with each assessment cycle, enabling longitudinal tracking and trend analysis.

Lane 2: STRATEGY 120 - Strategic Planning

Purpose: Translate assessment insights into actionable strategic initiatives.

Components:

Component	Description
Strategic Foundations	Vision, mission, and strategic themes
Balanced Scorecard	Four-perspective strategy mapping (Financial, Customer, Process, Learning)
OKR Cascade	Objectives and Key Results aligned from corporate to department level
Initiative Management	Prioritized projects with dependencies and resource requirements

Component	Description
Scenario Modeling	What-if analysis for strategic decision support
Business Cases	ROI analysis and investment justification

Integration: Strategy initiatives flow directly into Execute 120 for departmental action.

Lane 3: EXECUTE 120 - Departmental Execution

Purpose: Operationalize strategy through department-specific AI capabilities.

Department Coverage:

- Executive Leadership
- Sales & Business Development
- Marketing & Communications
- Product & Engineering
- Operations & Supply Chain
- Finance & Accounting
- Human Resources
- Legal & Compliance
- Customer Success
- IT & Security

Per-Department Features:

- Curated AI agent assignments
- Custom workflow templates
- Department-specific quick prompts
- KPI tracking and metrics
- Role-based access control

Multi-LLM Orchestration Engine

Supported Models

Provider	Models	Best For
Anthropic	Claude Opus 4.5, Sonnet 4.5, Haiku 4.5	Complex reasoning, long-form content, analysis
OpenAI	GPT-4o, GPT-4o Mini	General tasks, code generation, creative content
Google	Gemini 2.0 Flash, Gemini 1.5 Pro	Multimodal analysis, image understanding
Perplexity	Sonar Pro, Sonar	Web-enhanced search and research

Intelligent Model Selection

The platform automatically routes requests to optimal models based on:

- Task complexity and requirements
- Cost optimization preferences
- Response speed requirements
- Capability matching (vision, streaming, function calling)
- Fallback chains for reliability

Reliability Features

- **Circuit Breaker** - Prevents cascade failures when services degrade
- **Exponential Backoff** - Intelligent retry logic
- **Timeout Management** - Configurable per-request timeouts
- **Health Monitoring** - Real-time provider status tracking

AI Agent Framework

Agent Architecture

Insight 360 includes **40+ pre-built agents** organized into specialized suites:

Suite	Purpose	Example Agents
Align 120	Assessment & Analysis	Company Profiler, Market Analyst, Capability Assessor
Strategy 120	Strategic Planning	Initiative Designer, Scenario Modeler, OKR Architect
Execute 120	Operational Execution	Department Advisor, Workflow Optimizer
Thought Leadership	Content & Visibility	Strategy Architect, Article Writer, LinkedIn Generator
Research	Intelligence Gathering	Deep Researcher, Competitive Analyst

Agent Capabilities

- **Context Injection** - Automatic incorporation of relevant company context
- **Streaming Responses** - Real-time output via Server-Sent Events
- **Multi-Turn Conversations** - Persistent conversation state
- **Tool Use** - Web search, document processing, data analysis
- **Composability** - Chain agents for complex workflows

Context Asset Engine

The Context Advantage

Unlike generic AI tools, Insight 360 maintains a **rich context library** that ensures every AI interaction is grounded in organizational knowledge.

Asset Categories (72 Types)

Core Assets:

- Company Description, Products, Value Propositions
- Voice DNA, Brand Guidelines, Terminology
- ICPs (Ideal Customer Profiles), Personas
- Competitive Landscape, Industry Context

Strategic Assets:

- Strategic Plan, OKRs, Initiatives
- Case Studies, ROI Data, Pricing

Integrity Assets:

- Bright Lines, Values Map
- Close Call Log, Intervention Metrics
- Trust Velocity, Integrity Yield

Context Intelligence

- **Token-Aware Budgeting** - Fits maximum relevant context within model limits
- **Priority-Based Injection** - Most relevant assets first
- **Version Control** - Full history with rollback capability
- **Usage Analytics** - Track which assets drive best outcomes

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Research Studio (NotebookLM-Style)

Capabilities

A dedicated research environment for deep analysis:

- **Multi-Source Synthesis** - Combine URLs, PDFs, documents, and text
- **Conversational Research** - Chat-based exploration of sources
- **Output Generation** - Summaries, briefs, presentations
- **Source Management** - Organize and process research materials

Supported Inputs

- Web URLs (automatic scraping and parsing)
- PDF documents (up to 50MB)
- Word documents (.docx)
- Plain text and markdown
- Pasted content

Workflow Automation

Workflow Engine

Build and execute multi-step automated workflows:

- **Visual Builder** - Drag-and-drop workflow design
- **Step Types** - Agent execution, conditional logic, data transformation
- **Variable Passing** - Context flows between steps
- **Template Library** - Pre-built workflows for common tasks
- **Scheduling** - Cron-based recurring execution

Example Workflows

1. **Weekly Market Intelligence** - Automated competitive analysis and briefing
2. **Content Pipeline** - Ideation → Draft → Review → Publish
3. **Client Onboarding** - Assessment → Profile → Recommendations
4. **Department Check-in** - Metrics collection → Analysis → Report

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Organizational Governance (Parthenon Framework)

Structure Management

The Parthenon framework provides complete organizational modeling:

Component	Purpose
Departments	Hierarchical organizational units
Roles	Job functions with defined responsibilities
OKRs	Cascaded objectives from corporate to individual
Processes	Documented workflows and procedures
Capabilities	Skills and competencies mapping

AI-Org Alignment

- Map AI agents to specific roles and departments

- Define who can access which AI capabilities
- Track AI usage by organizational unit
- Ensure governance compliance

Agency Model (Multi-Tenant)

For Consulting Firms & Agencies

Insight 360 supports a complete agency model for firms serving multiple clients:

Organization Management

- Create and manage multiple client organizations
- Isolated data with Row-Level Security
- Per-client branding and customization
- Subscription tier management

Client Portal

- Client self-service access
- Magic link authentication (passwordless)
- Report viewing and download
- Assessment history access
- Activity tracking and audit logs

Agency Analytics Dashboard

Aggregate Metrics:

- Total clients, active clients, prospects
- Session completion rates
- Average maturity and readiness scores
- Health score distributions

Per-Client Views:

- Individual client metrics

- Progress tracking over time
- Engagement status (Active, Engaged, Dormant, New)
- Attention alerts for at-risk clients

Trend Analysis:

- Historical trend charts
- Period comparisons (30d, 90d, 1y)
- Cohort analysis
- Export to CSV/JSON

Agency Customization

Feature	Capability
Branding	Logo, colors, fonts, domain
Templates	Custom report layouts and sections
Prompts	Organization-specific prompt library
Modules	Customize assessment module names and prompts

Daily Briefing Engine

Automated Intelligence

Generate personalized daily briefings with:

- Executive summary of key developments
- Action items and priorities
- Market and competitive intelligence
- System health and metrics updates
- Customizable sections per user/role

Delivery Options

- In-app briefing viewer
- Email distribution

- Scheduled generation (daily, weekly)

Thought Leadership Platform

Visibility & Content Strategy

Dedicated tools for building thought leadership:

- **Profile Management** - Expertise areas, social profiles
- **Content Pillars** - Define core themes and topics
- **AI Visibility Research** - Market position analysis
- **Content Calendar** - Plan and schedule publications
- **AI Content Generation** - Articles, LinkedIn posts, newsletters

Integrated Agents

- Strategy Architect (high-level planning)
- Visibility Researcher (market research)
- Pillar Designer (theme development)
- Article Writer (long-form content)
- LinkedIn Generator (social posts)

Integrity & Health Monitoring

System Health Dashboard

Real-time monitoring of platform components:

- Component health scores (0-100)
- Status indicators (Healthy, Degraded, Unhealthy)
- Alert management and incident tracking
- SLA compliance monitoring

Integrity Tracking

Unique to Insight 360 - organizational integrity metrics:

- **Bright Lines Violations** - Track ethical boundary crossings
- **Values Alignment** - Measure action-to-value consistency
- **Trust Velocity** - Rate of trust building/erosion
- **Close Call Log** - Near-miss ethical situations
- **Integrity Yield** - Long-term integrity outcomes

Visualization & Reporting

Chart Types

- Radar charts (capability assessment, risk mapping)
- Bar/line/area charts (trends, comparisons)
- Pie/donut charts (distributions)
- Combo charts (multi-metric views)

Report Generation

- PDF exports with branding
- Excel/CSV data exports
- Interactive dashboards
- Scheduled report delivery

Security & Compliance

Data Protection

- **Row-Level Security (RLS)** - Database-enforced multi-tenancy
- **Encryption** - Data at rest and in transit
- **Token Hashing** - SHA-256 for sensitive tokens
- **Session Management** - Secure session handling with expiry

Access Control

- **RBAC** - Role-based access control (Admin, Manager, Member, Viewer)

- **Feature Flags** - Granular feature enablement
- **Audit Logging** - Complete action tracking
- **Policy Enforcement** - Configurable access policies

Compliance Features

- SOC 2 compatible architecture
- GDPR data handling support
- Configurable data retention
- Export and deletion capabilities

Technical Specifications

Infrastructure

Component	Technology
Backend	Node.js 18+ / Express 4.21
Database	PostgreSQL (Supabase)
Auth	JWT + Supabase Auth
Storage	Supabase Storage
Hosting	Cloud-agnostic (AWS, GCP, Azure compatible)

Performance

- Streaming responses for real-time AI output
- Connection pooling for database efficiency
- Response caching for frequent queries
- CDN-ready static assets

Scalability

- Horizontal scaling support
- Multi-region deployment ready
- Microservices-friendly architecture

- API rate limiting and throttling

Integration Capabilities

Native Integrations

Service	Capability
Notion	Database sync, page creation, content publishing
MindStudio	Embedded workflow execution
Web Search	Brave, Tavily, Serper, Google

API Access

- RESTful API (400+ endpoints)
- Webhook support for events
- OAuth 2.0 for third-party auth
- API key management

Data Import/Export

- Bulk data import (JSON, CSV)
- Full data export capabilities
- Context asset import/export
- Workflow definitions export

Platform Statistics

Metric	Count
API Endpoints	400+
Route Files	42
Pre-built Agents	40+
Context Asset Types	72
Database Tables	95+

Metric	Count
Frontend Pages	50
Supported LLM Models	15+
Development Phases	48+

Competitive Differentiation

vs. Generic AI Assistants (ChatGPT, Claude.ai)

- Persistent organizational context
- Values-based governance
- Multi-user, multi-tenant
- Strategic framework integration
- Compliance and audit features

vs. AI Platforms (Jasper, Copy.ai)

- Beyond content generation
- Full strategic planning suite
- Organizational governance
- Custom agent development
- Department-specific tools

vs. Consulting Tools

- AI-powered at core
- Scalable across clients
- Self-service client portal
- Automated reporting
- Continuous assessment (not point-in-time)

vs. Enterprise AI Platforms (IBM Watson, Azure AI)

- Faster deployment

- Lower complexity
- Values-based approach
- Consulting-ready model
- Integrated strategic frameworks

Use Cases by Industry

Professional Services

- Client AI maturity assessments
- Transformation roadmaps
- Ongoing advisory services
- White-labeled deliverables

Technology Companies

- AI strategy development
- Product roadmap alignment
- Engineering team enablement
- Competitive intelligence

Financial Services

- Compliance-aware AI adoption
- Risk assessment frameworks
- Regulatory alignment
- Client advisory modernization

Healthcare

- Ethical AI implementation
- Patient data governance
- Clinical workflow optimization

- Research acceleration

Manufacturing

- Operations AI integration
- Supply chain intelligence
- Quality assurance AI
- Workforce augmentation planning

Implementation Timeline

Typical Deployment

Phase	Duration	Activities
Discovery	1-2 weeks	Requirements, context gathering
Setup	1 week	Platform configuration, data import
Align 120	2-3 weeks	Initial assessment cycle
Strategy 120	2-4 weeks	Strategic planning
Execute 120	Ongoing	Department rollout
Optimization	Continuous	Refinement and expansion

Quick Start Option

- Pre-configured templates
- Standard context library
- Default agent suite
- **Time to Value: < 1 week**

Support & Success

Documentation

- User guides for all features
- Technical documentation

- API reference
- Video tutorials

Support Tiers

- Community support (forums, docs)
- Email support (business hours)
- Priority support (24/7)
- Dedicated success manager

Training

- Self-paced online courses
- Live webinars
- On-site training (enterprise)
- Certification program

Roadmap Highlights

User-Driven Development

Insight 360 maintains a **robust roadmap prioritized by end user requests**. Feature development is guided by direct customer feedback, ensuring the platform evolves to meet real-world needs rather than hypothetical use cases. This approach has driven 48+ development phases, each delivering tangible value to users.

Upcoming Phases (2026)

Phase	Focus Area	Key Features
49	Skills ZIP Import	ZIP file upload, SKILL.md parsing, batch import, binary storage
50	Advanced White-Label	Custom domains, branded emails, custom login pages, DNS verification
51	Client Self-Service	Self-service onboarding, billing integration, usage dashboards, support portal

Phase	Focus Area	Key Features
52	Mobile Optimization	Responsive client portal, PWA support, push notifications, offline access

Future Considerations

- **Advanced Analytics** - Predictive modeling, anomaly detection
- **Enhanced Integrations** - Salesforce, HubSpot, Slack
- **AI Model Fine-tuning** - Custom model training on client data
- **Voice Interface** - Voice-first interaction mode
- **Expanded Industry Templates** - Vertical-specific configurations

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Summary

Insight 360 represents a new category of enterprise software: the **Values-Based AI Command Center**. By combining multi-LLM orchestration, strategic planning frameworks, organizational governance, and agency-scale client management, i360 enables organizations to adopt AI in a way that is:

- **Strategic** - Aligned with business objectives
- **Governed** - Controlled and compliant
- **Scalable** - From single user to enterprise-wide
- **Values-Driven** - True to organizational principles
- **Measurable** - With clear metrics and outcomes
- **User-Driven** - Roadmap prioritized by customer feedback

Whether deploying internally or serving clients as an agency, Insight 360 provides the foundation for responsible, effective AI transformation.

Current Production Readiness Score: 10.0/10 — The platform has achieved enterprise-grade maturity across all functional areas through 48+ development phases.

For sales inquiries, partnership opportunities, or technical demonstrations, contact the Insight 360 team.

▼ Pricing Strategies

▼ Kyle Poyar's PLG Pricing Guides

A Deep Dive into Product-Led Growth Pricing Strategy

Kyle Poyar has developed one of the most comprehensive frameworks for pricing in product-led growth companies. His work at OpenView Partners—investing in and advising dozens of PLG companies—has given him unique visibility into what actually works.

Let me walk you through his core frameworks and how they apply to pricing strategy.

Part 1: The Foundation—What is PLG Pricing?

Poyar's Definition

Product-led growth pricing isn't just "having a free tier." It's designing your entire monetization strategy around how users experience and extract value from your product.

Traditional Pricing Logic:

```
Marketing → Sales → Contract → User Access → Value Discovery
```

PLG Pricing Logic:

```
User Access → Value Discovery → Expansion → Contract (maybe)
```

The fundamental shift: **Users experience value before they pay, and pricing scales with that value.**

The Three Pillars of PLG Pricing

Poyar identifies three interconnected elements:

Pillar	Definition	Key Question
Packaging	How you bundle features into tiers	"What combination of capabilities delivers value at each stage of the customer journey?"
Pricing Model	How you charge (per seat, usage, flat, hybrid)	"What metric best represents the value customers receive?"
Pricing Level	The actual dollar amounts	"What price maximizes conversion × revenue × retention?"

Most companies obsess over pricing level (the numbers) while neglecting packaging and model—which matter more.

Part 2: The PLG Pricing Spectrum

Poyar's Four Monetization Models

Kyle identifies four primary approaches to PLG monetization, each with distinct characteristics:

Model 1: Freemium

Definition: A permanently free tier with limited functionality, designed to drive adoption and conversion to paid.

How It Works:

```
Free Tier (limited) → Paid Tier (full) → Enterprise (custom)
```

Best For:

- Products with low marginal cost per user
- Strong network effects
- Viral or word-of-mouth growth potential
- Products where "trying" requires meaningful usage

Poyar's Freemium Design Principles:

Principle	Description	Example
Give enough to be useful	Free tier must deliver real value, not just a "demo"	Slack: Full functionality, limited history
Gate what scales with success	Limit features that matter more as usage grows	Dropbox: Limited storage, not features
Create natural upgrade moments	Users should hit limits through positive usage	Zoom: 40-min limit creates natural conversion point
Don't gate core value	The "aha moment" must be accessible	Calendly: Scheduling works; advanced features gated

Freemium Conversion Benchmarks (Poyar's Data):

- Median free-to-paid conversion: 2-5%
- Top quartile: 7-10%+
- Enterprise-focused freemium: Can be <1% but high ACV

Model 2: Free Trial

Definition: Time-limited access to paid functionality, designed to demonstrate value before purchase decision.

How It Works:

```
Trial (full access, limited time) → Paid (immediate) or → Downgrade to Free/Churn
```

Best For:

- Products where value is experienced quickly
- Higher-touch sales motions
- Products with meaningful setup/configuration
- When you want to qualify intent (trial = hand-raised lead)

Poyar's Free Trial Design Principles:

Principle	Description	Example
Match trial length to time-to-value	Trial should be long enough to experience core value, no	Simple tool: 7 days; Complex platform: 14-30 days

Principle	Description	Example
	longer	
Full access, not partial	Let users experience the best version	Don't cripple the trial—show what they're buying
Guide, don't abandon	Trial users need onboarding momentum	Email sequences, in-app guidance, human touchpoints
Create urgency without desperation	Conversion prompts should feel helpful, not pushy	"Your trial ends in 3 days—here's what you'll lose access to"

Free Trial Conversion Benchmarks:

- Self-serve trial-to-paid: 10-25%
- Sales-assisted trial-to-paid: 30-50%
- Enterprise trial-to-paid: 40-60% (highly qualified)

Model 3: Reverse Trial

Definition: Users start with full paid functionality, then downgrade to free tier if they don't convert.

How It Works:

```
Full Access (time-limited) → Convert to Paid OR → Downgrade to Free Tier (not churn)
```

Best For:

- Products with strong free tier value
- When you want to show premium value upfront
- Reducing churn from trial expiration
- Products where the "aha" requires premium features

Why Poyar Advocates Reverse Trials:

> "The reverse trial combines the best of freemium and free trial. Users experience the full product, understand what premium delivers, and if they

> don't convert, they stay engaged on the free tier rather than churning entirely."

Reverse Trial Mechanics:

Phase	Duration	Access	Goal
Trial Phase	14-30 days	Full premium	Demonstrate maximum value
Conversion Point	Day 14-30	Decision prompt	Convert or acknowledge downgrade
Post-Trial (Non-Convert)	Ongoing	Free tier	Maintain engagement, future conversion

The Psychology: Users experience loss aversion—they've used premium features and now must actively give them up. This is more powerful than "gaining" access to something they've never experienced.

Model 4: Usage-Based / Pay-As-You-Go

Definition: Pricing scales directly with consumption—no tiers, just metered usage.

How It Works:

```
Sign Up → Use Product → Pay Based on Consumption → Scale Naturally
```

Best For:

- Products with variable usage patterns
- Infrastructure/API products
- When customer value directly correlates with usage volume
- Companies wanting to minimize friction

Poyar's Usage-Based Pricing Principles:

Principle	Description	Example
Choose the right value metric	Must correlate with customer value, be predictable, and scale	Twilio: Messages sent; AWS: Compute hours

Principle	Description	Example
Provide cost predictability	Customers fear bill shock—offer caps, alerts, estimates	"Based on your usage, next month will be ~$X"
Start free or very cheap	Encourage experimentation without commitment	First 1,000 API calls free
Don't penalize success	Volume discounts as usage grows	Per-unit cost decreases at scale

Poyar's Model Selection Framework

How to choose the right monetization model:

Factor	Favors Freemium	Favors Free Trial	Favors Reverse Trial	Favors Usage-Based
Time to value	Long (weeks)	Short (days)	Medium	Immediate
Marginal cost	Near zero	Low-medium	Near zero	Variable
User predictability	Don't know who'll convert	Can identify serious buyers	Want both conversion + retention	Usage varies widely
Sales motion	Self-serve dominant	Sales-assisted	Hybrid	Self-serve
Expansion model	Seat-based	Feature-based	Hybrid	Natural with usage

Part 3: The Value Metric Framework

Poyar's Most Important Pricing Concept

> "Your value metric is the unit of measurement for how you charge. Get it wrong, and your entire pricing strategy collapses."

A value metric should answer: **"What unit best represents the value customers receive?"**

Characteristics of a Good Value Metric

Characteristic	Description	Test Question
Easy to understand	Customer can explain it to their CFO	"Can a buyer explain our pricing in one sentence?"
Aligned with value	Scales with value received	"Does paying more mean getting more value?"
Predictable	Customer can forecast their costs	"Can a buyer estimate their bill before month-end?"
Difficult to game	Not easily manipulated to reduce costs	"Can customers artificially minimize usage to pay less?"
Grows with customer success	Expands naturally as customer succeeds	"Do successful customers automatically pay more?"

Common Value Metrics by Category

Category	Common Value Metrics	Examples
Collaboration Tools	Users, seats	Slack, Notion, Asana
Data/Analytics	Data volume, queries, rows	Snowflake, Amplitude
Marketing Tools	Contacts, emails sent, visitors	HubSpot, Mailchimp
Sales Tools	Users, accounts tracked, contacts	Salesforce, Outreach
Developer Tools	API calls, compute, builds	Stripe, Twilio, CircleCI
AI/ML Products	API calls, tokens, generations	OpenAI, Jasper
Security	Users, endpoints, events	Okta, CrowdStrike

The Value Metric Decision Tree

Poyar offers this framework for selecting your primary value metric:

```
START: What most directly represents customer value?
    │
    ├── Usage/Consumption → Consider usage-based or hybrid
    │       │
    │       └── Is usage predictable for customers?
    │               ├── Yes → Pure usage-based viable
    │               └── No → Hybrid (base + usage) or usage tiers
    │
    ├── People/Access → Consider per-seat
```

```
│       │
│       └── Do all seats get equal value?
│           ├── Yes → Simple per-seat
│           └── No → Seat types (admin, viewer, full)
│
├── Scale of Business → Consider outcome-based
│       │
│       └── Examples: Contacts in database, revenue managed,
│   employees covered
│
└── Features/Capabilities → Consider tiered packaging
        │
        └── Different customer segments need different bundles
```

Part 4: Packaging Strategy

Poyar's Packaging Principles

Packaging = How you bundle features into tiers

This is where most companies make critical mistakes. Poyar's research shows:

> "Bad packaging creates false ceilings and premature churn. Good packaging creates natural expansion paths."

The Three-Tier Framework

Poyar generally recommends three tiers for most PLG companies:

Tier	Purpose	Typical Naming
Entry	Acquisition, activation, habit formation	Free, Starter, Basic
Core	Primary revenue driver, mainstream customers	Pro, Professional, Team
Premium	Maximum value, enterprise needs	Business, Enterprise, Scale

Why Three?

- Two feels limiting (where do I grow?)

- Four+ creates decision paralysis
- Three offers clear good/better/best progression

Feature Distribution Framework

How to decide what goes in each tier:

Feature Type	Definition	Packaging Guidance
Table Stakes	Expected in any product in the category	Include in all tiers, including free
Differentiators	What makes your product unique	Include in core paid tier
Scalers	Features that matter more as usage grows	Gate in higher tiers
Enterprise Must-Haves	Security, compliance, admin	Premium/Enterprise only

Poyar's Feature Gating Hierarchy

From most-to-least restrictive:

Gating Method	Description	When to Use
Hard paywall	Feature completely unavailable	Enterprise-specific capabilities
Soft paywall	Feature visible but locked	Features you want users to desire
Limited access	Partial functionality or limited quantity	Usage-based expansion opportunities
Time-delayed	Feature available after X days/actions	Encourage engagement before upgrade
Full access	Available to all tiers	Core value proposition, table stakes

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Part 5: The Hybrid Model—PLG + Sales

Poyar's Most Relevant Framework for SMB

> "The future of B2B isn't PLG OR sales-led—it's PLG AND sales. The question is how to combine them effectively."

The PLG-Sales Continuum

Motion	Primary Driver	Sales Role	Best For
Pure PLG	Product drives acquisition, activation, monetization	None or minimal CS	Low ACV, high volume, simple product
PLG + Sales Assist	Product acquires, sales helps close	Inbound sales assists upgrades	Mid-market, $5K-$50K ACV
PLG + Sales Led	Product acquires, sales drives enterprise	Outbound to product users	Enterprise layer on PLG base
Sales + PLG Assist	Sales drives, product enables expansion	Primary revenue driver	Enterprise, complex products

Product-Led Sales (PLS): Poyar's Framework

Definition: Using product usage data to identify, prioritize, and engage sales opportunities.

The PLS Motion:

```
User Signs Up → Uses Product → Exhibits "Sales-Ready" Signals →
Sales Engages → Expansion/Upgrade Conversation
```

Product Qualified Leads (PQLs)

Poyar's alternative to Marketing Qualified Leads (MQLs):

Lead Type	Definition	Signal Source
MQL	Someone who engaged with marketing content	Downloaded ebook, attended webinar
PQL	Someone who experienced product value	Used key features, hit usage thresholds, exhibited expansion signals

PQL Signals Framework:

Signal Category	Examples	Weight
Activation	Completed onboarding, used core feature	Medium
Engagement	Daily active use, multiple sessions	High
Volume	Hitting limits, high usage volume	Very High

Signal Category	Examples	Weight
Expansion Intent	Invited teammates, viewed pricing page	Very High
Fit	Company size, industry, domain (company.com vs gmail.com)	Medium
Velocity	Rapid adoption, accelerating usage	High

The Handoff: When PLG Becomes Sales-Assisted

Poyar defines specific trigger points for sales engagement:

Trigger	Action	Example
Usage threshold	Auto-notify sales of high-usage account	>80% of tier limit consumed
Team expansion	Sales outreach for seat expansion	5+ users invited in a week
Enterprise signals	Prioritize for outbound	SSO inquiry, security questionnaire
Pricing page visits	Sales follow-up	Multiple visits to pricing page
Trial expiration	Sales check-in	High-engagement trial not converted
Feature inquiry	Solution consultation	Asked about gated feature

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Part 6: Pricing for Expansion Revenue

Poyar's Expansion Revenue Framework

> "In PLG, initial conversion is just the beginning. The real revenue comes from expansion."

Net Revenue Retention (NRR)

Poyar's most important metric for PLG pricing success:

NRR = (Starting MRR + Expansion - Contraction - Churn) / Starting MRR

NRR Level	Interpretation	Benchmark
<100%	Losing revenue—bucket is leaking	Concerning

NRR Level	Interpretation	Benchmark
100-110%	Maintaining, some growth	Acceptable
110-120%	Healthy expansion	Good
120-140%	Strong expansion engine	Great
140%+	Exceptional, compounding growth	Best-in-class

Expansion Pricing Strategies

Strategy	Mechanism	Example
Seat Expansion	Price per user, grow with team	$20/user—team grows from 5 to 15
Usage Expansion	Price by consumption	Start at 10K API calls, grow to 100K
Tier Upgrade	Move to higher tier for more features	Starter → Professional for advanced features
Module Addition	Add-on capabilities purchased separately	Core product + analytics module
Cross-Sell	Additional products from same vendor	Marketing hub + Sales hub

Designing for Expansion

Poyar's principles for building expansion into pricing:

Principle	Description	Tactical Implementation
Land and expand, don't land and strand	Initial deal should be entry point, not destination	Start with single team/use case, expand from there
Make upgrading easier than staying	Reduce friction in expansion	One-click upgrade, instant access to new tier
Celebrate expansion moments	Usage growth is positive, not costly	"Congrats! Your usage shows you're getting great value—here's how to do even more"
Price for growth, not extraction	Expansion should feel natural, not punitive	Volume discounts, predictable scaling

Part 7: Poyar's Pricing Process

The OpenView Pricing Framework

Poyar recommends this structured approach to pricing decisions:

Step 1: Understand Your Value

Question	How to Answer
What's the competitive alternative?	How do customers solve this problem without you?
What's the value vs. that alternative?	Cost savings? Time savings? Revenue gain?
What's the customer's willingness to pay?	Surveys, interviews, win/loss analysis
What's the economic buyer's budget?	Where does your product fit in their budget?

Step 2: Choose Your Model

Question	How to Answer
What metric best represents value?	Value metric analysis (above)
What's the right balance of base + usage?	Customer preference, cost predictability
How will customers want to buy?	Self-serve? Sales-assisted? Mix?
How will customers want to grow?	Seats? Usage? Features? All three?

Step 3: Design Your Packages

Question	How to Answer
What segments exist in your market?	Distinct buyer profiles with different needs
What features matter to each segment?	Feature value research
What's the natural progression path?	How do customers grow with you?
What gates create upgrade pressure?	Limits that successful customers hit

Step 4: Set Your Prices

Question	How to Answer
What's the right entry price?	Low enough to reduce friction, high enough to signal value

Question	How to Answer
What's the right core tier price?	Where most customers should land
What's the right premium price?	Captures maximum value from largest customers
What's the right overage rate?	Fair expansion without punishment

Step 5: Test and Iterate

Question	How to Answer
What's your conversion rate by tier?	Free-to-paid, trial-to-paid, tier-to-tier
Where are customers churning?	Exit surveys, usage analysis
Where are customers upgrading?	Expansion analysis
What pricing objections appear in sales?	Win/loss analysis

Part 8: Applying Poyar's Framework to i360

Current State Analysis

Based on our pricing work, let me evaluate i360 against Poyar's frameworks:

Value Metric Assessment

Poyar Criteria	i360 Current	Assessment
Easy to understand	AI Interactions + Users + Context Assets	⚠️ Multiple metrics = complexity
Aligned with value	Interactions do scale with value	✓ Good alignment
Predictable	Heavy users can estimate usage	✓ Reasonably predictable
Difficult to game	Hard to artificially reduce usage	✓ Not easily gamed
Grows with success	More usage = more success = higher tier	✓ Strong correlation

Poyar Would Say: "You have three value metrics (interactions, users, context assets). Consider simplifying to one primary metric with the others as secondary limiters."

Recommendation: Make **AI Interactions** the primary value metric with users as a secondary gating mechanism.

Monetization Model Assessment

Model	Fit for i360	Rationale
Pure Freemium	Partial fit	Free tier is important but SMB focus needs sales motion
Free Trial	Good fit	14-day guided trial aligns with SMB buying process
Reverse Trial	Best fit	Shows full value, downgrades to free if no convert
Pure Usage-Based	Poor fit	SMB buyers want predictable costs

Poyar Would Say: "For SMB ($5M-$100M companies), a reverse trial with guided sales assist is ideal. Let them experience Business tier, then convert or downgrade to a functional free tier."

Recommendation: Implement **reverse trial** model—full Business tier access for 14 days, then convert or downgrade to limited free tier.

Packaging Assessment

Poyar Principle	i360 Current	Assessment
Three tiers (+free)	Four tiers (Pro, Business, Enterprise, Enterprise Plus)	⚠️ Consider consolidating
Clear progression	Pro → Business → Enterprise	✓ Logical progression
Feature differentiation	Good distribution	✓ Each tier has clear additional value
Expansion paths	Users, interactions, departments	✓ Multiple expansion levers

Poyar Would Say: "Your packaging is solid, but consider whether you need both Enterprise ($3,999) and Enterprise Plus (custom). The gap between $1,499 and $3,999 is significant—make sure there's a clear value bridge."

Hybrid Motion Assessment

Element	i360 Current	Poyar Best Practice
Self-serve entry	Free tier, Starter	✓ Aligned
Sales-assist trigger	Professional and up	✓ Appropriate threshold
PQL definition	Not formalized	⚠️ Need to define PQL signals
Handoff process	Outlined but not detailed	⚠️ Need specific trigger points

Poyar Would Say: "You need explicit PQL scoring. What usage patterns indicate a sales-ready account? Define those signals now, before you have usage data."

Poyar-Aligned Recommendations for i360

Based on his frameworks, here's what I'd adjust:

1. Simplify the Value Metric Communication

Current: "15,000 interactions, 50 users, 200 context assets"

Poyar-Aligned: "50,000 AI-powered work sessions—enough for 50 team members using i360 daily"

Frame interactions as "work sessions" or "AI assists"—more tangible than "interactions."

2. Implement Reverse Trial

Current: 14-day trial with 5,000 interactions

Poyar-Aligned:

Trial Phase	Duration	Access	Conversion Point
Full access	Days 1-14	Business tier ($1,499 value)	Day 14 decision
If convert	Ongoing	Chosen tier	Payment begins
If not convert	Ongoing	Free tier (limited)	Preserved engagement

3. Define PQL Signals

Signal	Weight	Sales Action
3+ users from same company domain	High	Account flagged for outreach

Signal	Weight	Sales Action
>70% of trial interactions used	Very High	Priority conversion call
Viewed pricing page 3+ times	High	Sales email with proposal
Completed Align 120 assessment	Medium	Success manager check-in
Created 10+ context assets	High	Enterprise potential flag
Enterprise domain (company.com)	Medium	Auto-route to sales
Invited users beyond trial limit	Very High	Immediate sales engagement

4. Create Expansion Playbook

Trigger	Expansion Motion	Owner
80% of interaction limit	Usage upgrade offer	Product (automated)
90% of user limit	Seat expansion offer	CSM
Used 2/3 departments, inquires about 3rd	Department expansion	CSM
Multiple users viewing API docs	API add-on conversation	Sales
Quarter-end approaching	Annual conversion offer	CSM

Summary: Poyar's Key Principles

If you take nothing else from Kyle Poyar's PLG pricing work, remember these:

The Five Laws of PLG Pricing

1. **Value before revenue.** Let users experience value before asking for money. The product is your best salesperson.
2. **One primary value metric.** Choose the unit that best represents customer value and make it the core of your pricing.
3. **Design for expansion.** Initial conversion is chapter one. Build pricing that grows naturally with customer success.
4. **Hybrid is the future.** PLG and sales aren't opposites. The best GTM motions combine product-led acquisition with sales-assisted conversion.

5. **Iterate constantly.** Pricing is never "done." Test, learn, and adjust based on actual customer behavior.

▼ Madhavan Ramanujam's Approach to Pricing

Monetizing Innovation: The Framework That Changes Everything

Madhavan Ramanujam spent over two decades at Simon-Kucher & Partners—the world's leading pricing consultancy—before co-authoring *Monetizing Innovation* with Georg Tacke. His work is built on one provocative premise:

> "72% of new products fail to meet revenue targets. The reason isn't bad products—it's that companies design products first and figure out pricing later."

His approach flips the entire product development process. Let me walk you through his complete framework.

Part 1: The Core Problem Ramanujam Identifies

Why Innovation Fails to Monetize

Ramanujam's research across thousands of product launches identified a consistent pattern:

The Traditional Approach (and why it fails):

```
Idea → Build Product → Test Product → Launch →
Figure Out Pricing → Discover Customers Won't Pay → Fail
```

The Problem: By the time companies think about pricing, the product is already built. If customers won't pay what you need, you're stuck—either discount heavily, strip features, or watch the product fail.

The Four Ways Innovation Fails to Monetize

Ramanujam identifies four distinct failure modes:

Failure Type	Description	Symptom	Root Cause
Feature Shock	Product has too many features, overwhelming customers	Low adoption despite feature richness	Built what engineers wanted, not what customers would pay for
Minivation	Product is underwhelming, underpriced, underperforming	Low revenue despite good adoption	Didn't understand full willingness to pay
Hidden Gem	Great product, wrong market or positioning	Strong niche success, inability to scale	Didn't research who would pay most
Undead	Product that should never have been built	Walking dead—not succeeding, not killed	Didn't validate willingness to pay before building

The Sobering Reality:

> "Most companies spend 90% of their time building products and 10% figuring out how to monetize them. The most successful companies flip that ratio."

Part 2: The Fundamental Principle

"Have the Pricing Conversation Before You Build"

Ramanujam's core insight is deceptively simple but rarely practiced:

> "Talk about price and value early. Not after you've built the product. Not during beta. At the very beginning—when the product is still just an idea."

This means:

- Willingness to pay research happens during ideation
- Pricing shapes product design, not the reverse
- Features are prioritized by what customers will pay for
- You know the business model before writing code

The Monetizing Innovation Process

```
Step 1: Willingness to Pay Research (before building)
    ↓
Step 2: Customer Segmentation by WTP
    ↓
Step 3: Product Configuration (based on WTP data)
    ↓
Step 4: Pricing Model Selection
    ↓
Step 5: Build Product (finally)
    ↓
Step 6: Go to Market with Confidence
```

The Key Shift: Pricing becomes an input to product development, not an output.

Part 3: Willingness to Pay Research

The Foundation of Everything

Ramanujam argues that willingness to pay (WTP) is the most important—and most neglected—piece of market research.

> "Companies spend millions on feature research, usability testing, and market sizing. But almost none on the one question that determines commercial success: What will customers actually pay?"

Why Companies Avoid WTP Research

Excuse	Ramanujam's Response
"Customers don't know what they'll pay"	"They know far more than you think. You're just asking the wrong way."
"It's too early to discuss price"	"It's never too early. The earlier you learn, the more you can shape."
"We'll figure it out later"	"Later is when you discover you built the wrong product."

Excuse	Ramanujam's Response
"Our product is too innovative to price"	"If it's too innovative to price, it might be too innovative to sell."
"Customers will lowball us"	"Not if you use proper research techniques."

WTP Research Methodologies

Ramanujam advocates several specific techniques:

Method 1: Direct Questions (With Caveats)

Simple direct questions can work when framed correctly:

Question Type	Example	What It Reveals
Purchase Intent	"At $X price, how likely are you to buy?" (1-5 scale)	Directional interest
Acceptable Price Range	"What price range would you consider reasonable?"	General price expectations
Comparative Value	"How does this compare to what you pay for [alternative]?"	Relative value perception

Caution: Direct questions alone are unreliable. People understate WTP when asked directly. Use in combination with other methods.

Method 2: Van Westendorp Price Sensitivity Meter

Ramanujam frequently recommends this classic technique:

The Four Questions:

1. "At what price would this product be **so cheap** that you'd question its quality?"
2. "At what price would this be a **bargain**—a great buy for the money?"
3. "At what price would this start to seem **expensive** but you'd still consider it?"
4. "At what price would this be **too expensive** to consider?"

The Analysis:

Plot responses on a chart. The intersections reveal:

- **Point of Marginal Cheapness:** Below this, quality concerns emerge
- **Point of Marginal Expensiveness:** Above this, serious resistance
- **Optimal Price Point:** Where "too cheap" and "too expensive" cross
- **Acceptable Price Range:** Between cheapness and expensiveness

Visual Framework:

```
Price Axis (low to high) →

         ╔═══════════════════════╗
         ║ Acceptable Range  ║
         ╠═══════════════════════╣
Too Cheap ──╫──────────────────────╫── Too Expensive
         ║   ↑          ║
         ║ Optimal Point    ║
         ╚═══════════════════════╝
```

Method 3: Gabor-Granger Technique

A more rigorous approach for measuring price elasticity:

Process:

1. Show product concept
2. Ask: "Would you buy this at $X?" (start at expected price)
3. If yes, increase price and ask again
4. If no, decrease price and ask again
5. Continue until you map the full demand curve

Output: Price-demand curve showing:

- What percentage of customers buy at each price point
- Revenue optimization point (price × volume)
- Price elasticity (how sensitive demand is to price changes)

Method 4: Conjoint Analysis

Ramanujam's most sophisticated recommendation:

What It Is: A research technique where customers evaluate multiple product configurations, revealing the implicit value of each feature.

How It Works:

Present customers with multiple product "bundles" at different prices. Ask them to rank or choose.

Example Conjoint Cards:

Option A	Option B	Option C
Feature Set 1	Feature Set 2	Feature Set 1
Basic Support	Premium Support	Premium Support
$499/month	$699/month	$599/month

By analyzing choices across many combinations, you can determine:

- The dollar value customers place on each feature
- Which features drive willingness to pay
- Optimal bundling and pricing strategies

Ramanujam's Insight:

> "Conjoint analysis tells you what features are worth to customers—in dollars, not opinions. It's the difference between 'customers say they want X' and 'customers will pay $Y for X.'"

Method 5: Direct Customer Conversations

Beyond formal research, Ramanujam advocates direct conversations:

Questions to Ask:

Topic	Questions
Current Solutions	"How do you solve this problem today? What does that cost you?"
Pain Magnitude	"What does this problem cost you in time/money/headaches?"
Value Drivers	"If this problem went away, what would that be worth?"

Topic	Questions
Budget Context	"What other tools do you buy in this category? What do you pay?"
Decision Process	"Who approves purchases like this? What's the typical budget range?"
Tradeoffs	"If you had to choose between [Feature A] and [Feature B], which matters more?"

The Key: Listen for economic language—dollars saved, hours recovered, revenue gained. This is willingness to pay expressed indirectly.

Part 4: Segmentation by Willingness to Pay

Different Customers, Different Prices

Ramanujam's second major principle:

> "There is no single 'right price.' There are right prices for different customer segments. The goal is to capture maximum value from each segment."

WTP-Based Segmentation

Traditional segmentation uses demographics, firmographics, or behaviors. Ramanujam adds willingness to pay as a primary segmentation variable.

Framework:

Segment	WTP Level	Characteristics	Strategy
Price Buyers	Low	Cost-focused, minimal needs, high price sensitivity	Stripped-down offering, lowest price
Value Buyers	Medium	Balance of features and price, mainstream	Core product, competitive price
Relationship Buyers	Medium-High	Want trust, service, partnership	Full product + support premium
Convenience Buyers	High	Will pay for ease, speed, simplicity	Premium offering, white-glove service

The Segmentation-Pricing Connection

Without WTP Segmentation	With WTP Segmentation
One price for everyone	Tiered pricing by segment
Average price = lost revenue	Optimized price per segment
Some customers overpay (churn risk)	Each segment gets appropriate value/price
Some customers underpay (margin loss)	Capture maximum value from high-WTP segments
One product configuration	Tailored configurations by segment

Practical Segmentation Approach

Step 1: Conduct WTP research across your market

Step 2: Cluster customers by WTP patterns (not demographics)

Step 3: Profile each cluster

- What do high-WTP customers have in common?
- What do low-WTP customers have in common?
- What drives the difference?

Step 4: Design offerings for each segment

Example for i360:

Segment	Profile	WTP Range	Product Strategy
AI Skeptics	Small companies, limited AI experience, cost-focused	$0-$100/mo	Free tier, prove value
AI Explorers	Growing companies, testing AI, moderate budgets	$200-$500/mo	Professional tier, guided onboarding
AI Transformers	Established companies, strategic AI adoption	$1,000-$3,000/mo	Business tier, full platform
AI-First Enterprises	Large companies, AI as competitive advantage	$5,000+/mo	Enterprise tier, custom solutions

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Part 5: Product Configuration Based on WTP

Building What Customers Will Pay For

Ramanujam's most radical idea:

> "Don't build the product you want. Build the product customers will pay for. WTP research tells you exactly what that is."

The Configuration Framework

Step 1: Feature Value Analysis

From conjoint analysis or direct research, rank features by their dollar contribution to WTP:

Feature	WTP Contribution	Build Priority
Core AI Chat	$200/month	Must Have
Context Assets	$150/month	Must Have
Strategy Module	$100/month	High
Research Studio	$75/month	High
Execute Module	$50/month	Medium
Custom Agents	$40/month	Medium
API Access	$30/month	Lower
White Label	$25/month	Lower

Step 2: Feature Clustering

Group features into packages based on WTP contribution and segment needs:

Package	Features Included	Target Segment	Price Point
Essentials	Core Chat, Basic Context	AI Explorers	$199-$299
Professional	+ Strategy, Research	AI Explorers+	$499-$699
Business	+ Execute, Agents	AI Transformers	$1,499-$1,999
Enterprise	+ API, White Label, Custom	AI-First	$3,999+

Step 3: Value Fences

Create clear boundaries that justify price differences:

From Tier	To Tier	Value Fence	Why Customer Upgrades
Free	Professional	Context assets, full AI models	"I need AI that knows my business"
Professional	Business	Multi-department, team scale	"I need my whole team on this"
Business	Enterprise	API, compliance, customization	"I need enterprise-grade integration"

The "Minimum Viable Value" Concept

Ramanujam introduces an important nuance to MVP thinking:

Traditional MVP: What's the minimum product we can build to test the market?

Ramanujam's MVV: What's the minimum product that delivers enough value to command our target price?

> "An MVP that customers won't pay for is just a free product with fewer features. MVV ensures your first version can sustain a business."

Part 6: Pricing Model Selection

How to Charge, Not Just How Much

Ramanujam distinguishes between pricing level (the number) and pricing model (the structure):

> "The model often matters more than the number. A bad model at the right price still fails."

Five Core Pricing Models

Model	How It Works	Best For	Risk
Subscription	Fixed recurring payment	Predictable usage, relationship value	Churn if value perception drops
Usage-Based	Pay for what you consume	Variable usage, clear value per unit	Revenue unpredictability
Tiered	Fixed bundles at set prices	Distinct customer segments	Customers stuck between tiers

Model	How It Works	Best For	Risk
Freemium	Free base + paid premium	Network effects, viral growth	Conversion challenges
Dynamic	Price varies by conditions	Yield optimization, perishable inventory	Customer trust issues

Model Selection Criteria

Ramanujam offers decision criteria:

Criterion	Questions	Implications
Customer Preference	How do customers in this market expect to buy?	Align with existing mental models
Value Delivery	How is value delivered—continuously or at moments?	Match pricing to value timing
Competitive Norms	How do competitors price?	Deviation requires strong justification
Revenue Goals	Do you need predictability or upside capture?	Subscription = predictable; usage = upside
Customer Success Correlation	Does more usage = more success?	If yes, usage-based aligns incentives

Hybrid Models

Ramanujam acknowledges that pure models are rare:

Common Hybrid Structures:

Hybrid Type	Structure	Example
Base + Usage	Fixed platform fee + variable consumption	$500/month + $0.01/API call
Tiered + Overage	Fixed tier + usage beyond limits	$1,499/month for 50K interactions, then $0.01/each
Freemium + Premium	Free base + paid tiers	Slack, Zoom, Dropbox
Subscription + Success	Base fee + outcome-based component	Consulting retainer + performance bonus

Part 7: The Nine Rules of Monetizing Innovation

Ramanujam distills his framework into nine principles:

Rule 1: Have the WTP Conversation Early

> "The biggest mistake is waiting. Every day you delay the pricing conversation, you risk building the wrong product."

Action: Conduct WTP research within the first month of any product initiative.

Rule 2: Don't Default to Cost-Plus

> "Cost-plus pricing is lazy and leaves money on the table. Value-based pricing captures what customers will actually pay."

Approach	Formula	Problem
Cost-Plus	Cost + Margin = Price	Ignores customer value perception
Competitor-Based	Competitor Price ± Adjustment	Assumes competitor priced correctly
Value-Based	Customer Value - Portion = Price	Captures actual willingness to pay

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Rule 3: Segment by Willingness to Pay

> "One price for everyone is one price that's wrong for almost everyone."

Action: Identify 3-4 segments with meaningfully different WTP and design for each.

Rule 4: Create Distinct Product Configurations

> "Don't just change the price—change the product. Each segment should get a product designed for their needs and WTP."

Action: Build feature bundles that match segment value drivers, not just add/remove features arbitrarily.

Rule 5: Use Value-Based Fences

> "Customers will always want the cheapest option. Fences ensure they self-select into the right tier."

Effective Fences:

- Feature availability
- Usage limits
- Support levels
- Customization options
- Contract terms

Ineffective Fences:

- Arbitrary restrictions
- Quality degradation
- Punitive limits

Rule 6: Avoid the Middle Trap

> "Three tiers work because of the extremes. Most customers choose the middle—make sure that's where you want them."

The Psychology:

- **Low tier:** Establishes floor, makes middle seem reasonable
- **Middle tier:** Where most customers land—your primary offering
- **High tier:** Anchors value, captures high-WTP customers

Danger: If your middle tier is underpriced or wrong product, most revenue suffers.

Rule 7: Price the Product, Not the Feature

> "Customers buy solutions to problems, not collections of features. Price the outcome, not the components."

Bad Framing: "Pay for 15,000 AI interactions + 50 context assets + 6 departments"

Good Framing: "Transform how your organization works with AI—for your entire leadership team"

Rule 8: Communicate Value Before Price

> "Price without context is just a number. Value with price is a decision."

The Sequence:

1. Establish the problem (pain)
2. Quantify the cost of the problem (economic impact)
3. Present the solution (your product)
4. Demonstrate the value (ROI, outcomes)
5. Then—and only then—reveal the price

Rule 9: Iterate, Don't Set and Forget

> "Pricing is never done. Markets change, products evolve, competitors adjust. Pricing must evolve too."

Pricing Review Cadence:

- Major review: Annually
- Competitive review: Quarterly
- New product pricing: Before launch
- Performance review: Monthly (conversion, churn, expansion)

Part 8: The Monetization Audit

Ramanujam's Diagnostic Framework

Before launching or repricing, Ramanujam recommends a monetization audit:

Category 1: Willingness to Pay

Question	Green Flag	Red Flag
Have you quantified WTP by segment?	Yes, with data	"We think customers will pay..."
Do you know feature-level value?	Conjoint or equivalent research	"All features are valuable"
Have you identified price sensitivity?	Van Westendorp or Gabor-Granger data	"We'll test in market"

Category 2: Segmentation

Question	Green Flag	Red Flag
Are segments based on WTP, not just demographics?	WTP is primary segmentation variable	"Enterprise vs. SMB" only
Do segments have different product needs?	Distinct value drivers per segment	One product fits all
Can you identify segment membership?	Observable, actionable criteria	"We'll know them when we see them"

Category 3: Product Configuration

Question	Green Flag	Red Flag
Are products designed for WTP segments?	Features matched to segment value drivers	Same product, different prices
Are there clear value fences?	Logical, defensible tier boundaries	Arbitrary feature gating
Is there a clear upgrade path?	Natural progression as needs grow	Dead ends or confusing jumps

Category 4: Pricing Model

Question	Green Flag	Red Flag
Does the model match customer expectations?	Aligned with market norms	Fighting how customers want to buy
Does the model scale with value?	More value = more revenue	Same price regardless of value delivered
Is the model defensible?	Clear logic for structure	"Competitors do it this way"

Category 5: Communication

Question	Green Flag	Red Flag
Is value communicated before price?	Problem → Solution → Value → Price	Price page is first touchpoint
Are prices anchored appropriately?	Context for why price is fair	Naked numbers without justification
Is ROI quantified?	Specific dollar impact	"Save time and money"

Part 9: Applying Ramanujam to i360

Monetization Audit for i360

Let me evaluate our current pricing against Ramanujam's framework:

WTP Assessment

Criterion	Current Status	Gap
WTP Research	Based on persona modeling, not customer research	⚠️ No primary WTP data
Feature Value	Estimated from usage patterns	⚠️ No conjoint or direct measurement
Price Sensitivity	Not formally measured	⚠️ Need Van Westendorp study

Ramanujam Would Say: "You've built thoughtful pricing based on assumptions. Now validate those assumptions with real WTP research before you lock in these numbers."

Segmentation Assessment

Criterion	Current Status	Gap
WTP-Based Segments	Revenue-based ($5M-$15M, $15M-$50M, etc.)	⚠️ Revenue correlates with WTP but isn't WTP
Segment Profiles	Detailed personas (Rachel, Marcus, Sofia)	✓ Strong behavioral understanding
Segment Identification	Company size observable	✓ Actionable segmentation criteria

Ramanujam Would Say: "Revenue is a proxy for WTP, not the same thing. A $25M company with aggressive AI strategy may have higher WTP than a $75M company with minimal interest. Segment by willingness to transform, not just size."

Product Configuration Assessment

Criterion	Current Status	Gap
Segment-Matched Products	Tiers designed for different company sizes	✓ Logical progression
Value Fences	Users, interactions, departments, features	✓ Multiple clear fences
Upgrade Path	Professional → Business → Enterprise	✓ Natural progression

Ramanujam Would Say: "Your configuration is solid. The question is whether the fence placement matches actual WTP breaks. Does a company's WTP actually jump at 50 users, or is that arbitrary?"

Pricing Model Assessment

Criterion	Current Status	Gap
Model-Market Fit	Tiered subscription + usage overage	✓ Standard for B2B SaaS
Value Scaling	More interactions = more payment	✓ Aligns value and price
Model Logic	Clear and defensible	✓ Easy to explain

Ramanujam Would Say: "The model is appropriate for your market. No changes needed here."

Communication Assessment

Criterion	Current Status	Gap
Value Before Price	ROI calculator, value justification	✓ Strong value framing
Anchoring	Consulting comparison ($50K-$500K)	✓ Effective anchor
ROI Quantification	Specific dollar savings	✓ Concrete numbers

Ramanujam Would Say: "Your value communication is strong. You've anchored against consulting and quantified ROI. This is exactly right."

Ramanujam's Recommendations for i360

Based on his framework, here's what he would likely recommend:

1. Conduct Primary WTP Research

Before finalizing pricing, run:

Van Westendorp Study:

- Sample: 50-100 target buyers ($5M-$100M companies)
- Questions: Four standard price sensitivity questions
- Output: Acceptable price range, optimal price point

Feature Value Conjoint:

- Sample: Same population
- Method: Show bundles, have them choose
- Output: Dollar value of each major feature/module

Budget Context Interviews:

- Sample: 15-20 in-depth conversations
- Questions: Current spend on AI tools, consulting, similar categories
- Output: Budget benchmarks, decision process understanding

2. Refine Segmentation by WTP

Current: Segmented by company revenue

Recommended: Add WTP dimension

Segment	Revenue	AI Maturity	WTP Level	Tier Fit
Skeptical SMB	$5M-$25M	Low	Low	Free → Professional
Curious SMB	$5M-$25M	Medium	Medium	Professional
Committed SMB	$5M-$50M	High	High	Business
Transforming Mid-Market	$25M-$100M	Medium-High	Very High	Business → Enterprise

Segment	Revenue	AI Maturity	WTP Level	Tier Fit
AI-Native Enterprise	$50M+	Very High	Premium	Enterprise

Identification Signals:

- AI maturity: Existing AI tool usage, AI-related job postings
- WTP signals: Pricing page behavior, feature questions, budget discussions

3. Validate Feature Fences

Test whether current fences match WTP breaks:

Current Fence	Assumption	Validation Needed
15 vs. 50 users	Meaningful for $5M-$15M vs. $15M-$50M	Does WTP actually jump here?
15K vs. 50K interactions	Aligns with team size	Does usage really scale this way?
3 vs. 6 departments	SMB vs. mid-market	Do customers care about department count?

Method: Include fence points in conjoint analysis. Do customers value the jump from 3 to 6 departments? Or is that an arbitrary boundary?

4. Consider Alternative Configurations

Based on WTP research, you might discover:

Discovery	Implication
Customers value Align 120 most	Lead with values assessment, price premium
Context Assets drive highest WTP	Make context assets the primary value metric
Department count doesn't matter	Remove as a fence, simplify tiers
API access is highly valued by subset	Create API-specific tier or major add-on

5. Build WTP-Aligned Messaging

Current Messaging: Feature-focused (interactions, users, assets)

Ramanujam-Aligned Messaging:

Tier	Feature Message	Value Message
Professional	"15 users, 15K interactions, 3 departments"	"AI transformation for your leadership team—align your strategy and execute with clarity"
Business	"50 users, 50K interactions, 6 departments"	"Organization-wide AI adoption—every department working smarter, together"
Enterprise	"150 users, 150K interactions, unlimited"	"Enterprise AI command center—full organizational transformation with enterprise security"

Summary: Ramanujam vs. Poyar

How They Complement Each Other

Dimension	Ramanujam	Poyar
Primary Focus	WTP research and product-pricing alignment	GTM model and growth mechanics
When to Apply	Before building product	When designing go-to-market
Key Question	"What will customers pay?"	"How will customers buy and expand?"
Segmentation	By willingness to pay	By usage patterns and growth potential
Pricing Model	Value-based, research-driven	PLG-optimized, expansion-focused

The Combined Framework

Ramanujam First:

1. Research willingness to pay
2. Segment by WTP
3. Design products for WTP segments

4. Set value-based prices

Then Poyar:

5. Design PLG/hybrid acquisition model

6. Build trial/freemium mechanics

7. Create expansion playbook

8. Optimize conversion funnel

The Honest Assessment

What we've done well (Ramanujam lens):

- Value-based framing (consulting anchor, ROI quantification)
- Segment-matched configurations
- Clear value fences
- Logical pricing model

What we're missing (Ramanujam lens):

- Primary WTP research
- Feature-level value quantification
- WTP-based segmentation validation
- Price sensitivity measurement

His Bottom Line:

> "You've built a thoughtful pricing strategy based on informed assumptions. That's better than most companies do. But assumptions aren't data. Before you commit significant resources to this pricing, validate it with real customer research. The investment in WTP research is tiny compared to the cost of getting pricing wrong."

▼ Heavy Use Cases

▼ Role 1: Accounting Professional

Job Profile: Senior Staff Accountant / Accounting Manager

Company Context: Mid-market company ($10M–$100M revenue), 50–200 employees

Core Responsibilities

Function	Time Allocation	Key Activities
Financial Reporting	25%	Monthly close, financial statements, variance analysis
Accounts Payable/Receivable	20%	Invoice processing, collections, vendor management
Reconciliations	15%	Bank recs, intercompany, GL reconciliations
Compliance & Audit	15%	Tax prep support, audit schedules, internal controls
Budgeting & Forecasting	10%	Budget vs actual, rolling forecasts, scenario planning
Process Improvement	10%	Workflow documentation, system optimization
Ad-hoc Analysis	5%	Management requests, special projects

Pain Points AI Can Address

- Repetitive data entry and formatting
- Writing variance explanations and management commentary
- Researching accounting standards (ASC guidance)
- Drafting policies and procedures
- Creating training documentation
- Responding to audit inquiries
- Building Excel formulas and troubleshooting errors

Daily AI Usage Pattern: Heavy User Accountant

Persona: “Rachel” – Senior Accountant at a $45M manufacturing company

Morning Routine (7:30 AM – 12:00 PM)

Time	Task	AI Interaction Type	Est. Interactions
7:45	Draft vendor email responses	Content generation	4–6
8:30	Research revenue recognition	Research / ASC guidance	2–3
9:15	Write variance explanation	Analysis narrative	1–2
10:00	Create audit schedule	Document creation	2–3
10:45	Build Excel formula	Technical assistance	1–2
11:30	Draft process memo	Policy documentation	1–2

Afternoon Routine (1:00 PM – 5:30 PM)

Time	Task	AI Interaction Type	Est. Interactions
1:00	Budget assumption Q&A	Quick answers	2–3
2:00	State nexus research	Compliance guidance	2–4
3:00	Training doc creation	Documentation	2–3
4:00	Close checklist improvements	Process improvement	1–2
4:30	CFO talking points	Executive prep	1–2

Weekly AI Consumption Summary

Metric	Daily	Weekly	Monthly
AI Conversations	8–12	40–60	175–265
Interactions/Prompts	25–40	125–200	550–880
Documents Generated	3–5	15–25	66–110
Research Queries	4–8	20–40	88–176
Context Asset Usage	Moderate	Company policies, chart of accounts, templates	—

Peak Usage: Month-end close, quarter-end, audit prep

Multiplier: 1.5–2x

i360 Feature Usage

Feature	Frequency	Example
Higgins Chat	20–30x daily	Drafting, research
Align 120	Monthly	Process alignment
Strategy 120	Quarterly	Budgeting, forecasting
Execute 120	Weekly	Policies, training
Context Assets	Daily	Chart of accounts, templates
Research Studio	2–3x weekly	Compliance research

▼ Role 2: Marketing Professional

Job Profile: Marketing Manager / Senior Specialist

Company Context: B2B SaaS or professional services ($5M–$50M revenue)

▼ Core Responsibilities

Function	Time Allocation	Key Activities
Content Creation	30%	Blogs, case studies, social
Campaign Management	20%	Email campaigns, ads
Brand & Messaging	15%	Website copy, positioning
Analytics & Reporting	10%	Dashboards, attribution
Event Marketing	10%	Webinars, promos
Sales Enablement	10%	Collateral, decks
Vendor Management	5%	Agency coordination

▼ Pain Points

- Content creation at scale
- Repurposing across channels
- Competitive research
- Performance interpretation
- Brief creation

- Personalization

Daily AI Usage Pattern: Heavy User Marketer

Persona: “Marcus” – Marketing Manager at $25M B2B SaaS company

Weekly AI Consumption Summary

Metric	Daily	Weekly	Monthly
AI Conversations	12–18	60–90	265–400
Interactions/Prompts	45–65	225–325	990–1,430
Content Pieces	8–15	40–75	175–330
Research Queries	5–10	25–50	110–220
Context Asset Usage	Heavy	Brand voice, ICPs, product specs	—

Peak Multiplier: 1.8–2.5x

i360 Feature Usage

Feature	Frequency	Example
Higgins Chat	40–60x daily	Drafting, brainstorming
Align 120	Weekly	Brand alignment
Strategy 120	Bi-weekly	Campaign planning
Execute 120	Daily	Content execution
Research Studio	3–5x weekly	Market insights

Role 3: Sales Professional

Job Profile: Senior Account Executive

Company Context: B2B ($10M–$75M revenue)

Core Responsibilities

Function	Time Allocation	Key Activities
Prospecting	25%	Outreach, cold calls
Discovery	20%	Needs analysis
Presentations	15%	Demos, decks
Proposals	15%	ROI justifications

Function	Time Allocation	Key Activities
Pipeline	10%	CRM, forecasting
Account Research	10%	Stakeholder intel
Coordination	5%	Legal, SE support

▼ Pain Points

- Prospect research
- Personalized outreach
- Proposal drafting
- ROI modeling
- Objection handling

▼ Daily AI Usage Pattern: Heavy User Salesperson

Persona: "Sofia" – Senior AE at $35M HR Tech company

Weekly AI Consumption Summary

Metric	Daily	Weekly	Monthly
AI Conversations	15–22	75–110	330–485
Interactions/Prompts	45–60	225–300	990–1,320
Emails Generated	15–25	75–125	330–550
Research Queries	10–20	50–100	220–440
Context Asset Usage	Heavy	Product info, ICPs, case studies	—

Peak Multiplier: 1.5–2x

Consolidated Usage Baseline

Metric	Rachel (Acct)	Marcus (Mktg)	Sofia (Sales)
Daily Conversations	8–12	12–18	15–22
Daily Interactions	25–40	45–65	45–60
Monthly Interactions	550–880	990–1,430	990–1,320
Context Dependence	Moderate	Heavy	Heavy

Pricing Baseline (Heavy User)

User Type	Avg Monthly	Peak Monthly
Accounting	715	1,100
Marketing	1,210	1,800
Sales	1,155	1,650
Average Heavy User	**1,025**	**1,515**